

Ending the Gaza War Must Restore Our Humanity

The Virtuous City Vision



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THE CORE THESIS

The Israeli-Palestinian conflict has long resembled a malformed bone: broken, poorly set, fractured again, and left to limp onward in dysfunction.

The bone can be reset properly, or harden again into another frozen conflict that guarantees the next war.

THE CORE THESIS · THE MOMENT



The hardened structure has briefly softened

- The Board of Peace is established
- Phase Two of Trump's 20-point plan is underway
- Enough pieces of the post-war mosaic are now visible to paint a new architecture for Israel, Palestine, and the wider Middle East

THE CORE THESIS · WHAT IS MISSING

✨ The civilizational soul

The current trajectory has real, if fledgling, momentum in diplomacy, seed money, and technocratic planning.



DIPLOMACY

real, if fledgling,
momentum



SEED MONEY

real, if fledgling,
momentum



TECHNOCRATIC PLANNING

real, if fledgling,
momentum



THE CIVILIZATIONAL SOUL

missing

What is missing is the civilizational soul capable of sustaining what the Trump administration is attempting: bringing Peace to the Middle East.

THE CORE THESIS · THE SCALE OF THE TASK

 Only a fraction of the money,
time, and collective will required

- The Trump administration deserves real credit for articulating a multi-billion-dollar economic vision to rebuild and reimagine Gaza as a regional economic hub
- This architecture must simultaneously restore Palestinian dignity and prosperity while recovering Israeli existential security
- Two nations that prize self-determination above all else
- Any architecture will inevitably step on the toes of both peoples · the international community will be asked to shoulder disproportionate responsibility for the consequences

THE CORE THESIS · THE VIRTUOUS CITY OF GAZA



More than a commercial or tourist center



A NUCLEUS

of intellectual, spiritual,
and moral renewal



A RECONCILIATION PROJECT

between Western and
Islamic civilizations



A COVENANT

that the Holy Land
must never again
become a battlefield for
reciprocal genocide



THE ARC

A telos, a coalition, and a generation

THE TELOS

the Virtuous City
of Gaza

THE COALITION

the Coalition for
Canaan, incubated
by the Board
of Peace

THE TRANSITION

demilitarization ·
freedom of
movement ·
reconstruction · the
West Bank

THE FRAMEWORKS

five reconciliation
frameworks · the
House of Wisdom
and Peace



1 · THE TELOS

The Telos of the Virtuous City of Gaza

Al-Farabi's Opinions of the People of the Virtuous City is more than an obscure utopian text preserved under the patronage of a bygone Abbasid Emir · it is the singular spiritual template for Gaza's rebirth

THE TELOS · ONE SUPREME PURPOSE



True happiness (sa'ada)

To enable every inhabitant to attain true happiness: the full actualization of human potential through intellectual perfection, moral virtue, civic cooperation, and the ultimate union with the divine, culminating in eternal felicity.

- A city is truly virtuous only when its leaders, institutions, education, and shared life mutually support this collective flourishing, in this world and the next
- Each part of society functioning harmoniously, like organs in a healthy body

A nucleus for a new social order and contract among Gaza's future inhabitants · the political and philosophical north star guiding reconstruction and nation-building after catastrophe

Plato's Republic, seeded with the soul of Medina

- An Arab-Islamic political and philosophical framework, developed at the height of the Islamic world's engagement with Greek, Jewish, and Christian thought
- Reason, revelation, ethics, and law existed in productive tension rather than outright opposition
- That intellectual milieu produced shared advances in philosophy, medicine, mathematics, and jurisprudence
- The connection to the divine as the ultimate pathway to happiness



Education as the foundation of renewal

FOR PALESTINIANS

Education has long functioned as a form of resistance: a way to preserve dignity, identity, and future orientation under occupation, displacement, and hopelessness · Gaza remains among the most educated societies in the Arab world relative to material conditions

WITH JEWISH ETHICAL TRADITIONS

Education, communal responsibility, wise and virtuous rulership, and collective flourishing resonate · a shared moral substrate through which both peoples can recognize legitimate authority, justice, and the *raison d'être* of their polity

The Virtuous City Vision elevates that instinct into the foundation of Palestinian rebuilding and national renewal.



Something Gaza has never been allowed to have

Gaza's modern political identity has been defined almost entirely by resistance, survival, and siege/occupation. The Virtuous City redefines that horizon toward human flourishing through moral, intellectual, and spiritual development.

WITHOUT A CLEAR TELOS

security architectures default to mere conflict management · economic visions risk devolving into a façade of permanent aid dependency

WITH THE VIRTUOUS CITY AS ITS NORTH STAR

Gaza's reconstruction becomes a civilizational project rather than a humanitarian holding pattern

Only once this foundation is established does it make sense to discuss disarmament, reconstruction, and a long-term security architecture.



What the polity is for · not how it is governed

IT DOES NOT CALL FOR

- a philosopher-king
- a clerical guardian
- an elitist Platonic ruling class

THE MECHANICS OF MODERN DEMOCRACY

- constitutional law
- civic accountability
- elected leaders who serve at the public's pleasure and can be voted out

A new telos for Gaza without a supporting architecture is just an aspiration. The current institutional framework, the Board of Peace, isn't yet able to bear its weight. That can be fixed.



2 · THE BOARD OF PEACE

Three Discordances and a Coalition

President Trump has articulated a broad vision for the Board of Peace as a new international peacemaking body · in its current form, three discordances will harm its ability to end the Israel-Hamas War



Mandate, coalition, and soul

1 · MANDATE

A tighter Gaza-first mandate, as initially framed, against the broader peacemaking body with global scope the Charter implies · a concern for many potential member states

2 · COMPOSITION

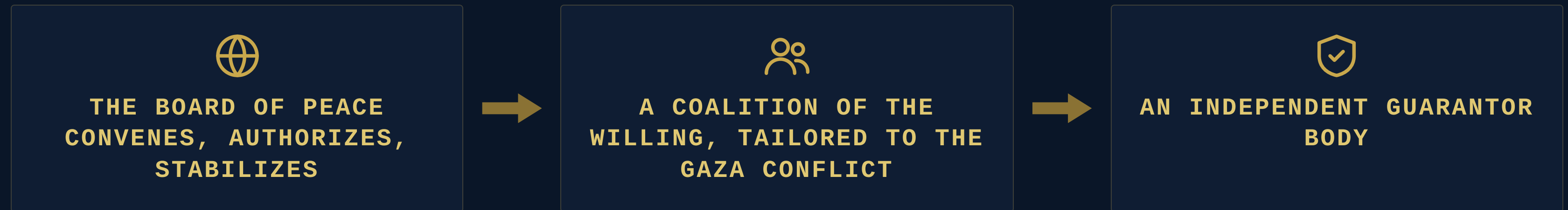
The current composition against the minimum viable coalition · the UK, France, Germany, and the Vatican refuse to join, and only a subset of its Members and Observers are materially significant to the conflict

3 · FOUNDATION

A transactional, administrative, and diplomatic mechanism · without an explicit philosophical and reconciliation substrate, it doesn't do justice to the human complexity of the conflict



An incubator, not an indefinite administrator



- The discordances do not require abandoning the Board of Peace · they require clarifying its structural role
- It should not administer Gaza indefinitely beyond its authorized two-year mandate
- Consistent with Article 3 of the Board of Peace Charter: a subsidiary coalition of the willing, the Coalition for Canaan
- A structural pathway for states reluctant to join the Board as currently conceived



The Five-Point Mandate



1 · MORAL

Break the cycle
of genocide



2 · POLITICAL

A generational,
time-bound
pathway to
Palestinian self-
governance



3 · HUMANITARIAN

Stabilize Gaza
and address its
humanitarian
catastrophe



4 · CIVILIZATIONAL

Heal the
Western–Arab
and Islamic
divide



5 · SPIRITUAL

Re-covenant the
sanctity of peace
in the Holy Land

A focused, semi-independent guarantor bloc, incubated and initially shepherded by the Board, for the broader Israeli–Palestinian conflict

THE FIVE-POINT MANDATE · 1 OF 5 · MORAL



Break the cycle of genocide

- Israelis widely view the October 7 attack as a genocidal massacre
- Palestinians widely view the subsequent Gaza war as genocide
- The Coalition commits to formally acknowledging these perceptions and preventing their recurrence



A generational, time-bound pathway to Palestinian self-governance

- Using the Trump Plan to end the Gaza war as a basis · over a 20 to 30-year horizon
- The Coalition lays the political, security, and institutional conditions for a Palestinian polity to serve Israel's long-term security interests
- The two-state formula will not be a panacea for the Holy Land · still, a credible exit plan for Palestinian self-governance is necessary for a stable interim regional order
- Under the 20-point plan, the PA has a pathway to return to Gaza within this timeframe, so we must plan for success

Stabilize Gaza and address its humanitarian catastrophe

- Implement the Trump administration's 20-point plan
- Guarantee Palestinian freedom of movement
- Rebuild and protect housing, education, and healthcare infrastructure for those who choose to stay

THE FIVE-POINT MANDATE · 4 OF 5 · CIVILIZATIONAL



Heal the Western–Arab and Islamic divide

- The divide this conflict continues to aggravate
- Economic coupling alone cannot resolve it

THE FIVE-POINT MANDATE · 5 OF 5 · SPIRITUAL

Re-covenant the sanctity of peace in the Holy Land

- Religious reconciliation frameworks will be developed
- Holy sites protected under negotiated covenants grounded in religious legitimacy
- Restoring the moral gravity that once restrained mass violence in the Holy Land



Who guarantees the architecture

INITIAL CORE MEMBERS

- Israel
- Palestine (PA)
- The core mediator states: the United States, Egypt, Turkey, and Qatar

LIKELY ADDITIONAL MEMBERS

- The UAE, Jordan, Saudi Arabia, Norway, the UK
- The Vatican, Germany, France, Italy, and the Netherlands

MAJOR ISF CONTRIBUTORS, ALSO CORE

- Indonesia
- Morocco
- Kazakhstan
- Kosovo
- Albania

They provide the core economic, security, humanitarian, and reconstruction guarantees · Board of Peace members and observers provide ancillary support · roughly one generation: an initial 10-year phase and two optional extensions

THE COALITION FOR CANAAN · A REPEATABLE MODEL



Guarantor coalitions wherever fault lines harden

Russia–Ukraine

Armenia–Azerbaijan

Cambodia–Thailand

DRC–Rwanda

India–Pakistan

future fault-lines not yet erupted

The strength of the model lies in its ability to stand up conflict-specific architectures, stabilize them, and allow them to mature into durable, self-sustaining frameworks for security.

3 · THE GENERATIONAL TIMELINE



Roughly 30 years, in three phases

DECADE 1 · STABILIZATION

- Demilitarize Gaza
- Stand up the Coalition of the Willing
- Establish the transitional government
- Begin reconstruction
- Lay the foundations for Palestinian self-governance

DECADE 2 · INTEGRATION

- Deepen Palestinian self-governance
- Expand economic ties with Israel and the region
- Advance the reconciliation and educational frameworks
- Continue normalization under the Abraham Accords

DECADE 3 · FULL MATURITY

- Mutual state recognition
- Voluntary confederation between Israel, Palestine, and the wider Middle East
- Complete Israeli military withdrawal
- Full implementation of the reconciliation frameworks

THE GENERATIONAL TIMELINE



Nobody disarms without a future.

This is by no means a utopian timeline. It represents a generational commitment to doing what no ceasefire, no peace deal, and no economic package has ever attempted: building something durable enough to endure and outlast the next crisis in the Middle East.

With a defined political horizon and substrate, a long-term demilitarization framework for the Strip becomes viable.



4 · DEMILITARIZATION

Demilitarization and the Political Transition of Resistance Factions

One Authority, One Law, One Weapon under legitimate Palestinian governance



Reciprocal, not unilateral surrender

- Adopts the disarmament, security-transfer, verification, and Israeli-withdrawal arrangements negotiated under the Board of Peace process · no competing framework
- Demilitarization must be inseparable from a credible political horizon, conditioned on the agreed withdrawal and political transition
- The Palestinian people's right to self-defense against indefinite occupation is a foundational principle · the settlement is legitimate only insofar as it honors that right through withdrawal and sovereignty

A demilitarized people under continuing occupation is not at peace but simply defenseless.

DEMILITARIZATION · A MATTER OF PRINCIPLE



Genocide as a technique of occupation

In *Axis Rule in Occupied Europe*, Raphael Lemkin described a way for an occupying power to secure in peace what it failed to win in war: coordinated political, economic, social, and cultural measures that dismantle the national pattern of the occupied and impose that of the occupier, and not only through mass killing.

A framework that disarms Palestinians while leaving permanent external domination in place would reproduce the conditions that sustain resistance and ultimately destabilize the settlement.

Indefinite occupation is no morally neutral substitute for war: it can undo a people without a shot being fired.



Factions relinquish coercive power as occupation recedes

ARMED FACTIONS SURRENDER

their final coercive lever against occupation
· because the alternative has already been tried, at enormous cost, and has not ended the occupation either

THE SETTLEMENT PROVIDES

phased Israeli withdrawal · credible regional and international security guarantees · an enforceable pathway to self-determination and statehood

- Responsibility for security passes to legitimate Palestinian institutions under Palestinian authority
- Egypt serves as the principal regional security anchor · the Coalition for Canaan sustains the broader framework beyond the Board of Peace process



Factions survive only by becoming genuinely political

- Armed resistance can only be durably displaced by a political system offering legitimate avenues for representation and national self-determination
- A pathway into ordinary political life, contingent on verified relinquishment of independent coercive capacity and adherence to the Five-Point Mandate
- A common rule of the transitional order, not a bespoke punishment for Hamas
- Operating through civilian institutions and accepting pluralist competition · material violations may result in proportionate political restrictions under Palestinian law

DEMILITARIZATION · INTO CIVILIAN LIFE



Demobilization without social destruction

amnesty where appropriate

employment

education

retirement

social support

safe relocation

reconstruction work through the Palestinian Labor Movement

Ending armed organizations without creating a permanently excluded class of former fighters vulnerable to radicalization, and building an order just and durable enough that renewed militancy no longer seems the only path left.



A genuine choice for those who wish to leave

No people should be forcibly confined to a devastated enclave after mass destruction. Ending cycles of genocidal violence requires not only protection for those who remain, but a genuine choice for those who wish to leave.

- The Coalition will negotiate, coordinate, and ensure pathways for asylum, temporary evacuation, and voluntary relocation during the reconstruction period
- Debated transparently and implemented through binding commitments by coalition member states · not left to ad hoc charity or discretionary border policies



FREEDOM OF MOVEMENT · TWO PATHWAYS

Temporary evacuation and asylum

TEMPORARY EVACUATION

Prioritizes civilians unable to safely remain during early reconstruction: the injured, the chronically ill, families with children, those at heightened risk of retaliation or political violence · voluntary, protective, and reversible, with guaranteed best-effort rights of return

ASYLUM

Permanent resettlement abroad, with legal resources, employment, education, and family reunification · negotiated with coalition states, monitored by the Board of Peace · case by case, for former faction members who renounced armed violence and face credible threats

Designed to reduce incentives for spoilers, enable demobilization, and prevent cycles of retaliatory violence.



Gaza must be rebuilt by Palestinians themselves

- A non-partisan Palestinian Labor Movement, fostered by the Board and Coalition, to absorb, preserve, and redeploy displaced Palestinian human capital
- Centering Palestinian labor agency is the clearest check against reconstruction that erodes local ownership and political autonomy
- Building on existing Palestinian labor institutions, outside factional politics during the transition
- Workers, engineers, teachers, healthcare professionals, civil servants, and demobilized fighters who renounce armed violence · the Palestinian Authority's reconstruction program as its baseline



A Compact of Free Association-style agreement

- The United States must play a central role in financing and supporting Gaza's economic revitalization
- A proto-compact between the United States and the Palestinian Authority: a legal basis for the American reconstruction vision for Gaza
- A pathway to integrate Gaza into global markets while preserving Palestinian agency, dignity, and self-determination
- The option to evolve into a full compact upon formal recognition of Palestinian statehood



RECONSTRUCTION · ARAB CAPITAL

Without Arab capital, Gaza will not be rebuilt

At least one Arab state designated as the primary Reconstruction Custodian for the Gaza Strip: partnering with the transitional government to lead fundraising and investment by the Arab and Islamic world, and serving as the Arab world's point woman for sustaining Gaza's revival.

THE UNITED ARAB EMIRATES

currently the most suitable candidate, given its humanitarian contributions to Gaza and its relations with the United States, Egypt, and Israel

SAUDI ARABIA

could also fill this role, creating a pathway toward normalization tied directly to the broader Israeli-Palestinian process

The choice carries major implications for the future regional order.

RECONSTRUCTION · A CENTRAL FINANCING PILLAR



Iranian frozen assets for the Trust Fund

- Redirect a portion of Iranian frozen assets toward the Gaza Reconstruction/Virtuous City Trust Fund, matched by members of the Board of Peace
- These assets roughly align in scale with the cost of rebuilding Gaza
- One of the few existing capital pools capable of underwriting reconstruction at the necessary scale
- It could emerge within a broader diplomatic framework focused on ending the 2026 Iran War



A Holy Land Trust for the occupied West Bank

Established by the Board of Peace to preserve a viable pathway toward Palestinian self-governance, uphold the Coalition's moral and political mandate, and enable deeper normalization with Syria and Lebanon.

Designed from inception as a framework expandable, as conditions permit, to other Israeli-occupied territories within a broader regional settlement framework.



Parallel, without prejudice

1 · EASEMENTS

internationally funded non-development
easements over a defined map of contiguity-
critical parcels

2 · USE PAYMENTS

from Israel, held in escrow, over the registered
footprint of existing settlements and outposts

Empty land shall remain empty. Built land shall remain limited to its registered footprint.

Neither ledger transfers title, recognizes annexation, or determines final borders · both convert into final-status instruments only upon a negotiated settlement



The national pattern of a people

- Members of the current Israeli governing coalition, like Itamar Ben-Gvir and Bezalel Smotrich, have articulated visions of settlement in the Occupied West Bank that result in the national destruction of the Palestinian nation
- Lemkin described genocide in two phases: the destruction of the national pattern of the oppressed group, then the imposition of the national pattern of the oppressor
- A dynamic that is actively occurring in the West Bank

The world cannot let this occur, if only to prevent the Jewish soul from being burdened with the crime of genocidal erasure of another people.

THE WEST BANK · BOTH SIDES



Palestinian wisdom, international manpower

PALESTINIAN LEADERSHIP

Palestinian reluctance must not become an obstacle · encouraging settlement in Area C as resistance will find limited success under occupation · any bridging mechanism must not become de facto permanent

THE INTERNATIONAL STABILIZATION FORCE

Explore pilot projects in the West Bank, toward the security architecture of a demilitarized Palestinian state · Israeli manpower constraints · rogue elements within the IDF and settler attacks, long unresolved

The unprecedented international willpower to provide manpower for both Israeli and Palestinian security must not go to waste due to short-term political calculations.

THE WEST BANK · A PRAGMATIC COMPROMISE



Keep the two-state horizon on its deathbed

rather than consigning it to the dustbin of history, preserving territorial compromise as an option for any future political settlement.

Because the West Bank remains the linchpin of broader Arab–Israeli normalization, the Board of Peace should pursue these initiatives under the Abraham Accords framework.



8 · REHUMANIZATION

Philosophy, Education, and Rehumanization in the Land of Canaan

Security arrangements and economic reconstruction cannot hold if the underlying civilizational logic remains broken



Narratives that render the Other subhuman

- No postwar framework can succeed without confronting the philosophical and educational drivers that sustain this conflict
- Each nation remains trapped in narratives that render the Other as illegitimate, subhuman, or eternal enemy
- Point 18 of the 20-point plan must be operationalized and institutionalized into durable curricula, civic programs, and shared reference points
- No illusions about hardened attitudes, grief, rage, or the current emotional weather on either side

The purpose here is definition, not conclusion: to name the missing frameworks so that future generations of leaders can build them into something real.



At the heart of the Virtuous City Vision



1

The Telos of the
Virtuous City of
Gaza



2

The Five-Point
Mandate of the
Coalition for
Canaan



3

Shared
Canaanite
ethno-genesis



4

The Judeo-
Islamic
Tradition



5

The Broader
Abrahamic
Tradition

- 1–2 · the civilizational and political conditions under which reconstruction and normalization become mutually intelligible
- 3–5 · educational and rehumanization frameworks, jointly supported by Israel, Palestine, and the Coalition for Canaan



FRAMEWORKS · 1 AND 2 OF 5

The telos and the mandate

1 · THE TELOS

The future Palestinians must be able to operationalize, and Israelis must be able to see · Gaza's telos cannot merely be the absence of rockets · a Gaza oriented toward education, civic virtue, and human flourishing becomes a security gain rather than a strategic risk

2 · THE MANDATE

The geopolitical philosophy governing the Architecture: reciprocal obligations, grounded in geopolitical reality · constraints Israel must accept for long-term regional legitimacy, guarantees Palestinians must see · inspired by Ben-Gurion's early vision of Israel and its sister Arab state in an Arab regional Federation

Together: reconstruction and normalization become mutually intelligible rather than mutually threatening.



Shared Canaanite ethno-genesis

- An anthropological rehumanization framework that acknowledges the shared ethnogenesis of the Israeli and Palestinian nations, rooted in the Land of Canaan
- Recognizing divergence, admixture, and other complexities
- Without adjudicating modern indigeneity, sovereignty, religion, or national identity
- Highly contested in both nations · contention over claims of indigeneity and sovereignty will not be eliminated

The Formal Establishment of the Judeo-Islamic Tradition

- Formalizing the shared philosophical, theological, and intellectual heritage of Jews and Muslims
- The very milieu in which the Virtuous City emerged
- A buried civilizational overlap that can be taught without forcing theological merger or political surrender

The Formal Establishment of the Broader Abrahamic Tradition

- Consolidating interfaith initiatives into a coherent framework, with shared educational programs
- Covenants of coexistence, restraint, and mutual recognition among Jews, Muslims, and Christians
- Especially around contested holy sites, where sanctity must once again become covenant

Both traditions belong within the Abraham Accords: extending normalization beyond diplomatic recognition into structured civilizational, educational, and religious reconciliation architecture.

REHUMANIZATION · A PRECEDENT



Two very unlikely souls

RABBI MENACHEM FROMAN

West Bank settler rabbi

AHMED YASSIN

Hamas founder and spiritual leader

They sought to ground conflict resolution through both Halakha and Sharia. Their effort did not succeed politically, but it perhaps offers the best prototype of the type of formal religious dialogue necessary to bring peace to the Holy Land.

Together, the five frameworks are the moral, educational, and civilizational architecture to move the conflict beyond its zero-sum logic, toward a durable, enforceable peace that operates at the spiritual level.



The Board of Peace's keystone initiative

Not a cultural side-project or an NGO vanity mission, but the intellectual anchor of the Virtuous City Vision.

- This is where Truth and Reconciliation work must actually live
- The originating institution for the educational and interfaith reconciliation frameworks
- Where scholars, clerics, educators, and civic leaders formally develop the curricula, covenants, and shared moral language needed to seed peace across generations

Without an intellectual engine that can produce and legitimize reconciliation frameworks, Israelis and Palestinians will relapse into internecine conflict.



Civilizations can grow through contact

- The original House of Wisdom was a crossroads where the Islamic and Western worlds met through philosophy, science, and medicine
- Modern discourse has flattened the relationship between Islam and the West into a clash of civilizations revolving around oil, geopolitics, and resentment
- A yin-and-yang character: for every era of conquest and violence, an equal and opposite force of transmission, synthesis, and mutual enrichment

The House of Wisdom represented the light within that historical collision.

THE HOUSE OF WISDOM · A WAGER



Not an anachronism

Building a House of Wisdom and Peace in Gaza is a wager that civilizational collision can once again leave a constructive mark upon holy ground long scarred by conflict.

**IF IT CANNOT RISE FROM THE ASHES OF
GAZA**

the Board of Peace will never be more than a
vanity project

IF IT DOES

the Board of Peace would have earned its
name and place in the annals of history

Anyone who has lived through these past 900 days has had to ask themselves one unavoidable question:

What the fuck was all this for?

THE CLOSE · AN AMORPHOUS MOMENT



The status quo is unacceptable

- We have witnessed the darkest moments in the Israeli–Palestinian conflict by far · the trajectory on both sides resembles nothing less than full national erasure
- A rare phase when a conflict that has ossified for generations briefly loses its fixed shape · Israelis and Palestinians alike must seize it
- One point of consensus cuts across both nations, regardless of ideology: the status quo is unacceptable
- Like it or not, Donald Trump is uniquely positioned: the political legitimacy, institutional leverage, and force of personality to impose a decisive end to the war



THE CLOSE · HAMAS AND THE PALESTINIAN PEOPLE

What's the worth of ruling over nothing but rubble?

- Palestinian steadfastness has always been about remaining on the land under overwhelming pressure
- Gaza has been reduced to rubble, and the Palestinian national project remains on its deathbed, despite unprecedented popular support for its liberation movement
- The international community will not finance the rebuilding of a territory governed by a people who are structurally committed to another catastrophe
- The Virtuous City Vision affirms the Arab-Islamic nature of the Gaza Strip while engaging the West without capitulation or secular erasure

If Hamas seeks a future beyond governing ruins, endorsing the Virtuous City Vision is the most coherent path available to transform resistance into political survival, dignity, and renewal.

THE CLOSE · THE SO-CALLED TWO-STATE SOLUTION



No illusions, and no abandonment

NO ILLUSIONS

In every version ever proposed, a Palestinian “state” is better understood as an autonomy framework with constrained sovereignty, foreign dependencies, and permanent infringements on security · a century of trauma will not dissolve because borders are redrawn

ABANDONING IT WOULD BE A STRATEGIC ERROR

A credible pathway toward Palestinian self-governance remains the only long-term political horizon capable of anchoring Israel’s regional integration, stabilizing the Holy Land, and reducing the perpetual existential insecurity of Jewish and Palestinian life

THE CLOSE · ISRAEL'S FOUNDING IMAGINATION



The moral wager of 1948

The moral wager was that Israel would become a legitimate state for the safety and security of the Jewish people, and not a messianic engine of hegemony that hardens the region and world against its trajectory.

The Virtuous City Vision, while centered on Gaza, attempts to revive and modernize the alternative trajectory embedded in Israel's own founding imagination, including Ben-Gurion's openness to regional federation and binational or confederal horizons with the Arabs.

What is proposed here does not ask Israelis or Palestinians to pretend that history can be undone, identities dissolved, or grievances erased.

It asks only that the war end decisively.

Periodic wars punctuated by brief ceasefires are morally and strategically unacceptable.

If there is any unifying truth left after these 900 days of devastation, it is this:

the planetary devastation that
we have all borne in our nervous
systems must never occur again.

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Named in the text: Raphael Lemkin, *Axis Rule in Occupied Europe* · President Trump’s 20-point plan for Gaza (Point 18) · the Board of Peace Charter (Article 3) · the Abraham Accords

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